

LASHUNTA

| COMMON LASHUNTA HUMANOID

The elegant humanoid form associated with modern lashuntas is the product of deliberate biological revision. Their distant ancestors were upright, chitinous predators native to **Velis**, with segmented limbs, layered eyes, pronounced mandibles, armored bodies, and movements that many humanoid ancestries still find difficult to interpret. They developed natural telepathy while coordinating silent hunts through the dense psionic ecosystems of their homeworld, then spent centuries learning to manipulate the relationship between thought, heredity, and physical development.

Long before the **Star Dream**, lashunta physicians and psionic naturalists had developed **somatic revision**, a combination of genetic therapy, guided metamorphosis, developmental medicine, and telepathic conditioning. Early revisions protected communities from disease, neurological degeneration, environmental toxins, and the rapid changes of Velis's biosphere. Later generations used the same disciplines to alter sensory structures, cognition, musculature, stature, and appearance.

The Star Dream transformed a medical tradition into a civilizational argument. Lashuntas who received the revelation saw distant peoples whose bodies repeatedly followed a broadly humanoid pattern. Some interpreted this recurrence as evidence that the Elect were meant to converge. Others believed a more familiar shape would make peaceful contact possible. Many simply feared that the other recipients of the Dream would never treat an armored insectoid predator as an equal.

These pressures produced three dominant adult expressions. **Damayas** adopt tall, graceful, highly attractive humanoid bodies optimized for psionic control, social perception, fine coordination, and sustained intellectual work. **Korashas** adopt shorter, denser humanoid bodies shaped for strength, physical endurance, rapid reaction, and disciplined aggression. **Katalash** refine their ancestral form instead, retaining layered eyes, chitin, mandibles, segmented anatomy, and the predatory traits that Damayas and Korashas removed.

Damayas and Korashas gained access to diplomacy, trade, compatible equipment, political recognition, and intersystem institutions. Katalash communities argue that these advantages were purchased by making lashuntas attractive, legible, and nonthreatening to foreign peoples. Most Damaya and Korasha institutions answer that adaptation prevented isolation and possible war.



The argument has never been resolved. It has only been absorbed into the employment practices, developmental programs, beauty standards, and security policies of the Settled Systems.

If you want to roleplay a telepathic character whose body reflects generations of self-revision, assimilation, beauty, ancestral anger, and disagreement over what acceptance is worth, you should play a lashunta.

YOU MIGHT...

- ◆ Be acutely aware of how appearance changes the patience, trust, desire, or fear other people show you.
- ◆ State your emotions and intentions openly because you consider that context necessary for honest communication.
- ◆ Feel pride, resentment, doubt, or political responsibility regarding the adult expression you inhabit.

OTHERS PROBABLY...

- ◆ Assume you can read thoughts, detect lies, or understand feelings that were never communicated to you.
- ◆ Expect a Damaya to be gentle and emotionally available, a Korasha to be disciplined and protective, or a Katalash to be hostile.
- ◆ Idealize, fetishize, distrust, or fear you before learning anything about your actual personality.

PHYSICAL DESCRIPTION

All lashuntas possess two long sensory antennae extending from the forehead or upper skull. These organs detect subtle environmental disturbances and help focus the psionic impulses used for telepathic communication. Their motion often accompanies expression, though antennae are not a reliable substitute for asking what a lashunta thinks or feels.

Damayas are tall, slender, and deliberately graceful. Their bodies emphasize bilateral symmetry, fine facial control, smooth or lightly patterned skin, large readable eyes, and proportions that produce broad and repeatable attraction among humanoid ancestries. Their skulls and nervous systems support precise telepathic focus, memory, sensory integration, and prolonged concentration.

Damayas retain enough alien traits to be recognizably lashunta. Their antennae remain prominent, and many possess small chitinous ridges around the brow, temples, shoulders, or spine. Fine scales, sensory nodules, unusual pigmentation, and geometric facial markings are common. These features are usually arranged around an otherwise humanoid face rather than replacing it.

Korashas possess shorter, broader, and more muscular bodies. Their skeletons, connective tissues, and nervous systems are reinforced for physical labor, rapid movement, and violent impact. Their faces remain

recognizably humanoid and are frequently considered attractive, though heavier jaws, stronger brows, thicker skin, visible chitin, and prominent cranial ridges are more common than among Damayas.

The Korasha body is built to appear powerful without appearing uncontrolled. Settled Systems media favors Korashas whose strength is balanced by symmetry, composure, clean posture, and disciplined movement. An attractive Korasha is expected to look capable of violence while reassuring observers that the violence will be directed only where authorized.

Katalash retain bodies much closer to the ancestral lashunta form. Most possess layered or partially compound eyes, pronounced mandibles, armored faces, digitigrade legs, segmented limbs, hooked fingers, dense chitin, and abrupt movements shaped by predatory reflexes. Some possess hardened cranial crests, secondary mouthparts, additional sensory structures, or reinforced lower limbs capable of sudden acceleration.

Most humans and other predominantly humanoid peoples find Katalash physically intimidating and substantially less attractive than Damayas or Korashas. Their faces provide fewer familiar emotional signals, their eyes can appear unblinking, and their mouths resemble those of dangerous native fauna. These responses are not universal, but they are consistent enough to affect employment, diplomacy, media representation, and ordinary social treatment.

Katalash do not consider themselves undeveloped Damayas or Korashas. Their bodies undergo extensive revision and often possess sophisticated adaptations unavailable to either humanoid expression. They chose heightened perception, protection, mobility, and environmental resilience without removing the traits that made ancestral lashuntas difficult for foreigners to look at.

Lashunta children are born in transitional bodies containing traits shared by all three expressions. Near adolescence, they begin a developmental process called the **Second Emergence**. Genetic therapies, psionic exercises, hormonal regulation, nutritional controls, surgical intervention, and one or more guided metamorphic stages gradually establish the adult body.

The Second Emergence is described as a personal choice. The treatment required for each expression varies enormously in availability and cost. Families, schools, employers, governments, religious communities, and political movements frequently influence which options a young lashunta can realistically pursue.



A wealthy lashunta may revise their expression later in life. Poorer lashuntas are usually limited to the treatment their family could afford or the expression an employer was willing to sponsor.

SOCIETY

Velis lies near the frontier edge of the Settled Systems. Distance, dangerous transit conditions, and political caution made lashuntas one of the last major ancestries of the Elect to establish sustained contact with the other recipients of the Star Dream.

Before intersystem contact, lashunta civilization consisted of independent cities, ecological territories, defensive settlements, and psionic research traditions. Telepathy supported rapid coordination, but it never created a hive mind or eliminated conflict. Lashunta politics became highly attentive to emotional motive because people could communicate private context more directly than ordinary speech allowed.

Modern lashunta culture continues to value deliberate self-development. Education commonly combines academic study, physical discipline, emotional literacy, telepathic control, and examination of personal motivation. Lashuntas are encouraged to distinguish between what they desire and what their family, expression, employer, or community trained them to desire.

The ideal is rarely achieved without contradiction. Damaya families often direct children toward scholarship, medicine, diplomacy, performance, administration, or prestigious social professions. Korasha families frequently treat physical strength and protective service as obligations owed to the community. Katalash communities may pressure young lashuntas to retain ancestral traits as proof that their people have not surrendered.

Modern lashunta politics are divided into three broad tendencies.

Accommodationists believe entry into the Settled Systems required compromise. Most Damaya and Korasha institutions fall within this tendency. They argue that attractive humanoid bodies allowed lashuntas to secure recognition, technology, political influence, and peace. A people who refused to account for the instincts and limitations of its neighbors would have condemned Velis to isolation.

Preservationists believe Katalash communities require legal autonomy, ancestral education, compatible infrastructure, and freedom from developmental pressure. They do not necessarily demand that Damayas or Korashas abandon their bodies, but they reject the idea that convergence should remain the social default.

Restorationists believe Damayas and Korashas are products of submission. They seek a broad return to ancestral or near-ancestral bodies and frequently describe humanoid expressions as domesticated forms. Moderate Restorationists pursue cultural separation and independent medical institutions. Extremist cells have attacked revision clinics, destroyed developmental records, threatened accommodationist families, and targeted Erbium facilities.

Damaya and Korasha institutions often portray all Katalash political anger as evidence of instinctive aggression. Katalash movements answer that calmness is easy to praise when the system rewards your body and describes your submission as maturity.

Lashunta communication is emotionally explicit by Settled Systems standards. A lashunta might begin a difficult conversation by saying, “I am angry, though not entirely with you,” or, “I want you to agree with me, and I recognize that desire may be affecting my judgment.” Such declarations are considered useful context rather than extraordinary vulnerability.

This candor does not prevent deception. Lashuntas can lie through telepathy as easily as through speech. Their reputation for honesty comes from social convention and emotional literacy, not biological inability.

BELIEFS

Many lashuntas believe a person possesses an inherited self and a cultivated self. The inherited self includes biology, instinct, family, history, and circumstances beyond individual control. The cultivated self is produced through discipline, reflection, revision, and deliberate action.

Damaya traditions often treat beauty as a form of cultivated harmony. Physical symmetry, controlled movement, health, social awareness, telepathic precision, and emotional composure are considered evidence that the individual has brought body and mind into alignment. Critics argue that this definition conveniently resembles the qualities rewarded by Settled Systems employers.

Korasha traditions emphasize mastery over strength and aggression. Power is considered valuable when disciplined and directed toward protection, service, or a chosen purpose. A Korasha who loses control is often judged more harshly than another ancestry committing the same act because their expression is understood as a promise that their strength will remain governed.

Katalash traditions value continuity with the body that survived Velis before contact. Anger is not treated as a failure of self-command when it accurately responds to injury, humiliation, or coercion. Many Katalash teachers argue that constant emotional calm primarily benefits the people causing the harm.

The principal accommodationist philosophy is called **Convergence**. It teaches that the humanoid pattern seen throughout the Star Dream reflects a meaningful direction in the development of the Elect. Its followers regard Damaya and Korasha bodies as chosen participation in an intersystem future.

The principal Katalash philosophy is called **Continuity**. It teaches that altering oneself under foreign pressure is not liberation merely because the alteration is technologically sophisticated. Continuity accepts medical and genetic improvement but rejects humanoid appearance as the default measure of advancement.

Erbium promotes a third philosophy called **Applied Expression**. It describes every body as a tool selected to fulfill a chosen purpose. Damayas are suited to communication, Korashas to action, and Katalash to specialized environmental work. The philosophy is presented as neutral, though Erbium controls which purposes receive funding and employment.

Popular Edicts cultivate your abilities deliberately, communicate emotional context honestly, protect mental autonomy, defend the expression you chose, understand how beauty and fear influence judgment

Popular Anathema intrude upon another person's mind without consent, compel somatic revision, conceal coercion behind the language of improvement, judge virtue by attractiveness, demand emotional calm solely for the comfort of an oppressor

SAMPLE NAMES

Common lashunta names include Amashel, Domash, Hesori, Imaaz, Kima, Kopalo, Maenala, Nomae, Oraeus, Raia, Shess, Soryn, Stretto, Taeon, Tarevi, Varikuara, Vesh, Ymaera, and Zorash.

Many lashuntas possess both a spoken name and a telepathic introduction. The telepathic component may communicate the name with intended pacing, emphasis, emotional context, or personal associations, but contains no information that could not also be explained through ordinary language. A lashunta may use different introductions in professional, familial, ceremonial, and intimate settings.

OTHER INFORMATION

VELIS

Velis is a warm, biologically dense world of towering vegetation, deep wetlands, seasonal forests, and heavily interconnected ecosystems. Its native life evolved amid naturally occurring psionic phenomena produced by biological electrical fields, mineral formations, atmospheric conditions, and mechanisms that remain poorly understood.

These phenomena influence animal migration, predator behavior, reproduction, communication, and territorial patterns. Lashunta telepathy developed as part of this ecology rather than as an isolated supernatural gift.

Ancestral lashuntas were coordinated pursuit and ambush predators. Their early communities used silent communication to surround prey, warn one another of danger, and organize movement through vegetation where sight and sound were unreliable.

As permanent settlements developed, those same abilities supported medicine, collective planning, ecological observation, and warfare. Lashunta cities were built as defended islands within hostile environments, connected through carefully monitored routes and extensive warning networks.

Somatic revision began as a response to rapidly changing diseases and environmental pressures. Velis's natural psionic fields allowed lashunta researchers to study how thought, neural development, and bodily metamorphosis influenced one another. This work eventually produced the techniques used during the Second Emergence.

The Star Dream reached Velis before its people possessed reliable intersystem travel. Lashuntas spent generations debating the humanoid figures seen within the revelation before meeting them directly. Early Damaya and Korasha programs were already underway when sustained contact finally began.

THE SECOND EMERGENCE

The Second Emergence usually begins during adolescence and continues across several local years. The process modifies the developing body gradually enough to preserve neural stability and telepathic function.

A candidate undergoes genetic sequencing, psionic assessment, metabolic preparation, developmental counseling, and repeated medical review. The most intensive stages require controlled metamorphic chambers in which portions of the body are softened, resorbed, rebuilt, or reinforced.

Damaya programs devote considerable resources to cranial development, fine sensory control, facial musculature, skeletal elongation, and telepathic precision. Korasha programs reinforce the skeleton, musculature, nervous system, cardiovascular function, and protective tissues. Katalash programs preserve or expand chitin, mandibles, layered vision, rapid movement, environmental perception, and other ancestral systems.

The process is not risk-free. Poorly maintained clinics, interrupted treatments, incompatible gene packages, and rushed developmental schedules can cause chronic pain, neurological injury, sensory instability, physical asymmetry, or incomplete metamorphosis.

Erbium and aligned institutions sponsor Second Emergence programs for adolescents who sign developmental service agreements. Damaya sponsorship commonly leads into personnel management, health services, diplomacy, recruitment, or public communications. Korasha sponsorship commonly leads into security, rescue, hazardous engineering, and industrial service.

Katalash programs receive less support. Corporate medical formularies classify many ancestral traits as culturally elective adaptations rather than employment-relevant development.

DAMAYAS

Damayayas represent the most extensive convergence with humanoid appearance. They receive disproportionate opportunities in diplomacy, medicine, counseling, education, entertainment, administration, hospitality, and public relations.

The advantages are real. Damayas are more readily trusted, desired, accommodated, and invited into positions of social influence than other lashunta expressions.

These advantages come with demands. A Damaya is expected to remain attractive, composed, socially perceptive, emotionally articulate, and available to manage the feelings of others. A Damaya who is blunt, private, visibly angry, physically unattractive, or unwilling to perform emotional labor is frequently treated as wasting the purpose of their expression.

Corporate supervisors often describe Damaya emotional labor as a natural aptitude rather than a learned professional skill. Their presence is used to calm workers, soften disciplinary proceedings, increase customer compliance, and make corporate representatives appear compassionate.

KORASHAS

Korashas represent the Settled Systems' preferred form of controlled strength. Their bodies are physically capable, visibly powerful, and familiar enough to remain reassuring to humanoid observers.

Korashas dominate security, emergency response, military contracting, industrial rescue, enforcement, hazardous maintenance, and physically demanding frontier work.

Their strength is often treated as public property. Employers assume Korashas should accept danger, communities expect them to intervene in violence, and coworkers may judge refusal as cowardice or selfishness.

Korasha anger is accepted when directed at approved threats. It is treated as instability when directed at supervisors, institutions, or the conditions under which Korashas are expected to sacrifice themselves.

KATALASH

Katalash preserve and enhance ancestral lashunta morphology. Their bodies are generally less attractive to humanoid observers, more difficult to accommodate, and more likely to provoke instinctive fear.

Katalash communities do not consider those reactions morally neutral. They argue that Damayas and Korashas reshaped themselves around the preferences of foreign peoples and then renamed the resulting benefits self-improvement.

Anger occupies a central place in many Katalash cultures. It is treated as evidence that a boundary has been crossed, a memory has been preserved, or a harm has not been converted into polite abstraction.

This cultural acceptance of anger does not make every Katalash violent. It does make their political movements more confrontational than most Damaya or Korasha institutions. Demonstrations commonly include intimidation, destruction of corporate property, refusal of telepathic de-escalation, and deliberate use of

ancestral body language that other peoples find threatening.

Katalash movements are vulnerable to purity politics. Some communities question the loyalty of members who use humanoid clothing, live among other ancestries, or accept Erbium equipment. Restorationist extremists have coerced adolescents away from Damaya and Korasha programs while claiming to defend them from coercion.

The conflict therefore cannot be reduced to courageous Katalash resistance against passive collaborators. Katalash grievances are substantial, their anger is often justified, and some of their movements reproduce the same denial of individual choice they condemn.



TELEPATHIC ETIQUETTE

Lashunta telepathy is deliberate communication. It does not allow passive access to unspoken thoughts, hidden memories, or objective truth.

Consent remains central to traditional etiquette. Sending a brief telepathic warning during an emergency is acceptable. Repeatedly addressing an unwilling person mentally is treated as an intimate form of harassment.

Many lashuntas send emotional context alongside their words. This context may communicate reassurance, urgency, anger, grief, attraction, or uncertainty. It does not force the recipient to experience the emotion and cannot communicate information beyond what ordinary speech could express.

Damaya culture tends to encourage rich emotional context. Korashas often prefer concise context suited to coordination. Katalash communication frequently includes emotional intensity that accommodationist institutions consider unnecessarily aggressive.

The Settled Systems routinely misunderstand these differences. Damayas are expected to share emotional context on demand. Korashas are expected to suppress it during service. Katalash are penalized for communicating anger too directly.

THE IDEAL LASHUNTA

Erbium Industries helped establish the Damaya as the public image of the lashunta ancestry: beautiful, perceptive, composed, sexually attractive, articulate, and capable of understanding others without making demands of their own.

Damaya actors, diplomats, counselors, physicians, reception personnel, recruiters, and corporate representatives appear throughout Erbium media. Their antennae and markings signal diversity while their bodies remain compatible with human-standard clothing, furniture, architecture, and beauty products.

Korashas became the secondary ideal: attractive protectors whose strength is reassuring because it remains disciplined, professional, and institutionally directed.

Katalash appear in corporate media primarily as extremists, wilderness specialists, historical ancestors, security threats, or comparisons to dangerous Velish fauna. Even neutral reporting tends to emphasize mandibles, chitin, abrupt movement, and anger.

Erbium publicly recognizes every expression as valid. Its hiring systems, sponsored development, equipment standards, advertising, housing, and security classifications overwhelmingly favor two.

PLACE IN THE SETTLED SYSTEMS

Damayayas are heavily represented in diplomacy, counseling, medicine, entertainment, recruitment, education, administration, personnel management, public relations, and customer-facing authority. Their telepathy and appearance are treated as professional assets, while the emotional labor demanded from them is rarely compensated separately.

Korashas are heavily represented in security, emergency response, military contracting, industrial rescue, hazardous engineering, enforcement, and Frontier Extraction Division operations. Employers frequently treat the choice of a Korasha expression as prior consent to physical danger.

Katalash are concentrated in independent Velish settlements, frontier enclaves, ecological work, hostile-environment surveying, heavy extraction, political movements, and communities with their own equipment standards. They undergo additional screening at ports, government offices, corporate housing, and medical facilities.

Human-standard equipment often fails to accommodate Katalash mandibles, chitin, digitigrade legs, layered eyes, or sensory structures. Institutions classify compatible equipment as a special accommodation even when established designs already exist.

Settled Systems governments formally prohibit discrimination between lashunta expressions. They continue to recognize appearance requirements, customer-confidence policies, equipment-compatibility standards, security-risk assessments, and employer-sponsored developmental agreements that reproduce much of the same hierarchy.

Erbium benefits from the resulting conflict. Damayas and Korashas are presented as proof that cooperation brings prosperity. Katalash militancy justifies surveillance, travel controls, developmental oversight, and expanded corporate security authority.

LASHUNTA MECHANICS

HIT POINTS

6

SIZE

Medium

SPEED

25 feet

ATTRIBUTE BOOSTS

Charisma, Free

LANGUAGES

Common

Velish

Additional languages equal to your Intelligence modifier, if it is positive. Choose from the list of common languages and any other languages to which you have access, such as languages prevalent on your home world.

LIMITED TELEPATHY

You can communicate mentally with creatures within 30 feet. You can communicate only with creatures that share a language with you. This doesn't give you access to their thoughts, and it communicates no more information than normal speech would.

EMOTIONAL CONTEXT

When you communicate using your Limited Telepathy, you can intentionally include a broad impression of your present emotional state. This can communicate feelings such as reassurance, urgency, anger, grief, attraction, or uncertainty, but it cannot transmit thoughts, memories, or information beyond what ordinary speech could express. It cannot force the recipient to experience the emotion.

Once per 10 minutes, when you communicate telepathically with a creature that shares a language with you, you can make your emotional context explicit. Before the end of your next turn, you gain a +1 circumstance bonus to your next Diplomacy or Intimidation check against that creature. Until then, that creature gains a +1 circumstance bonus to Sense Motive against you.

Heritages

DAMAYA LASHUNTA

Your Second Emergence produced a tall, graceful humanoid body shaped around beauty, fine sensory control, telepathic precision, memory, and sustained intellectual work. Your features were deliberately developed to appear attractive, emotionally readable, and nonthreatening according to the dominant standards of the Settled Systems. Settled Systems institutions frequently presume that a Damaya is educated, respectable, socially competent, and familiar with professional etiquette. This presumption can benefit Damayas who possess none of those qualities and burden those who are expected to remain beautiful, composed, emotionally available, and grateful for the access their expression provides.

Your appearance conforms closely to the beauty standards promoted throughout the Settled Systems. You gain a +1 circumstance bonus to checks to **Make an Impression** on a creature that can clearly perceive your appearance and whose culture broadly recognizes Damaya presentation as attractive or socially desirable. This bonus applies whether you attempt the check using Diplomacy or another skill. It doesn't apply if the creature is Hostile toward you, is specifically prejudiced against Damayas, or belongs to a community that rejects Convergence and its beauty standards.

Your developmental education included the etiquette, credentials, terminology, and procedural habits expected within Settled Systems institutions. You become trained in Society. If you would already become trained in Society from your background or class,

you instead become trained in another skill of your choice. When you attempt to **Make an Impression** on or **Request** something from an employee, official, administrator, academic, physician, or other representative of a formal Settled Systems institution, you can roll Society instead of Diplomacy. You must be able to present yourself through the institution's expected language, etiquette, credentials, or procedures. This ability doesn't allow you to falsify credentials you don't possess, though it can allow you to recognize which credentials are expected and how they would ordinarily be presented.

You gain an attribute boost to Intelligence and an attribute flaw to Constitution. Your free ancestry boost can't also be applied to Intelligence.

KORASHA LASHUNTA

Table Note

Encourage the other players to track their characters' Bulk. A Korasha's expanded carrying capacity matters most when someone needs to be dragged out of a wreck, carried away from danger, or relieved of heavy equipment. It takes a village.

Your Second Emergence produced a compact, muscular humanoid body reinforced for physical endurance, rapid reaction, violent impact, and controlled aggression. Your appearance remains conventionally attractive and recognizably humanoid, while heavier chitin, reinforced joints, dense musculature, and a lower center of gravity distinguish you from a Damaya. Settled Systems institutions treat the Korasha body as a promise of useful strength. Employers assume you can carry more, work longer, enter danger sooner, and absorb risks that would be considered unreasonable for another employee. Your physical ability earns respect so long as it remains disciplined and directed toward an approved purpose.

Your reinforced skeleton, dense musculature, and connective tissues are developed for sustained labor and heavy loads. You become trained in Athletics. If you would already become trained in Athletics from your background or class, you instead become trained in another skill of your choice. In addition, you can carry 2 additional Bulk before becoming encumbered and can hold or lift 2 additional Bulk beyond your normal maximum.

You have been trained to apply strength through leverage, balance, and deliberate movement rather than uncontrolled exertion. You gain a +1 circumstance bonus to Athletics checks to **Force Open**, **Shove**, or **Trip**. When you critically fail an Athletics check to Force Open, Shove, or Trip, you can treat the result as a failure instead. Once you use this benefit, you can't use it again for 10 minutes.

You gain 8 Hit Points from your ancestry instead of 6. You also gain an attribute boost to Strength and an attribute flaw to Wisdom. Your free ancestry boost can't also be applied to Strength.

UNBOUND LASHUNTA

You did not complete a recognized Damaya, Korasha, or Katalash Second Emergence. You might possess a combination of traits from several expressions, have interrupted your development, survived an incomplete metamorphosis, or deliberately pursued a body that existing programs do not recognize.

Your body might be tall and muscular, short and lightly built, asymmetrical, partially chitinous, unusually scaled, or otherwise difficult to classify. Institutions frequently treat Unbound lashuntas as medically unfinished even when their body is precisely what they intended. You can take Lashunta ancestry feats with a prerequisite requiring a specific Lashunta heritage or expression, including Damaya, Korasha, or Katalash, provided you meet all other prerequisites and the feat's level is no greater than half your level. You count as possessing the required heritage or expression only for selecting and using that feat. You don't gain that heritage's traits, attribute modifiers, Hit Points, Basic Katalash Benefits, or any other abilities unless the feat specifically grants them.

You also gain the Unbound Mind reaction.

UNBOUND MIND

Trigger You attempt a saving throw against a mental effect, but you haven't rolled yet.

You reject the attempt to impose another creature's will upon your mind. You gain a +1 circumstance bonus to the triggering saving throw and to other saving throws against mental effects until the start of your next turn.

ARMORED KATALASH LASHUNTA

KATALASH

Your Second Emergence developed dense overlapping chitin across your torso, limbs, neck, and skull. These plates flex around your joints while dispersing impacts that would tear or sever softer bodies.

You have **Basic Katalash Benefits**. You gain resistance to slashing damage equal to half your level, with a minimum resistance of 1.

Your chitin is a living part of your body. Damage to it can be treated using Medicine and restored through ordinary healing.

PURSUIT KATALASH LASHUNTA

KATALASH

You preserve the reinforced hind limbs, forward balance, sudden acceleration, and functional wings of an ancestral Velish pursuit predator. Two or more folded insectoid wings emerge from reinforced structures along your upper back, opening into thin, durable flight membranes supported by chitinous veins. Your body is built to close distances quickly, navigate broken terrain, and pursue prey through Velis's dense forests, wetlands, and elevated vegetation.

You have **Basic Katalash Benefits**. Your Speed is 30 feet instead of 25 feet. You gain a 15-foot Fly Speed. You gain a +1 circumstance bonus to Athletics checks to High Jump or Long Jump. When you Leap horizontally, increase the distance you Leap by 5 feet.

FACETED-SIGHT KATALASH LASHUNTA

KATALASH

Your layered eyes process several overlapping fields of vision, supported by secondary sensory structures along your antennae, brow, and jaw. Motion that would escape humanoid sight remains visible to you.

You have **Basic Katalash Benefits**. You gain darkvision. When you use the Seek action, you can search a 60-foot cone or a 30-foot emanation instead of the normal area.

RENDING KATALASH LASHUNTA

KATALASH

Your Second Emergence preserved and reinforced the mandibles and hooked claws of ancestral lashuntas. These structures remain useful for pursuit, climbing, confined movement, and close combat.

You have **Basic Katalash Benefits**. You gain a mandibles unarmed attack that deals 1d6 piercing damage. Your mandibles are in the brawling weapon group and have the unarmed trait. You also gain a claws unarmed attack that deals 1d4 slashing damage. Your claws are in the brawling weapon group and have the agile, finesse, and unarmed traits. Your mandibles and claws are biological parts of your body. Handwraps of mighty blows and similar effects apply to them normally.

Katalash Benefits

BASIC KATALASH BENEFITS

KATALASH

Every heritage with the Katalash trait grants the following benefits.

HIT POINTS

You gain 8 Hit Points from your ancestry instead of 6.

ATTRIBUTE BOOSTS

Strength

Constitution

Free

ATTRIBUTE FLAW

Charisma

These replace the attribute boosts normally granted by your lashunta ancestry.

KATALASH

You gain the Katalash trait. You count as a Katalash lashunta for prerequisites, equipment, abilities, and effects that distinguish between lashunta expressions. You retain your Limited Telepathy and Emotional Context ancestry abilities.

PSIONIC-PATHOS PREDATOR

You can detect the emotions of others, though you lack the ability to sort out the complexities of these emotions. You gain emotion sense as an imprecise sense with a range of 30 feet. This means you can detect and determine the location of creatures that possess emotions. You gain a +2 circumstance bonus to Perception checks when using the Seek action to find hidden or undetected creatures within the range of your emotion sense who's under an emotion effect, such as rage, the frightened condition, or any spell with the emotion trait.

ALIEN BEARING

Your layered eyes, mandibles, predatory posture, abrupt movements, and emotionally intense telepathy are difficult for most Settled Systems peoples to interpret without fear or discomfort.

You take a –2 circumstance penalty to Diplomacy checks to **Make an Impression** or **Request** something from a creature that is not a Katalash lashunta.

This penalty doesn't apply if the creature is already Helpful toward you. The GM can also waive this penalty for a creature whose background, community, or personal experience has made them meaningfully familiar with Katalash bodies and communication.

Alien Bearing doesn't affect Gather Information, Deception, Intimidation, or any other use of Diplomacy.

RUNNING KATALASH SOCIAL FRICTION

Alien Bearing represents the immediate difficulty Katalash experience when attempting to gain trust or voluntary cooperation from people unfamiliar with their bodies. Wider institutional prejudice should usually appear through attitudes, procedures, and material barriers rather than additional universal numerical penalties.

Within Erbium facilities, government offices, major ports, corporate housing, medical institutions, and other human-standard environments, an unknown Katalash may begin one attitude step worse than an equally situated Damaya, Korasha, or human visitor. This usually means beginning Unfriendly rather than Indifferent. It should rarely make a creature automatically Hostile.

Common forms of discrimination include additional security screening, refusal to accept telepathic communication, demands that the Katalash restrain their antennae or mandibles, denial of equipment on compatibility grounds, insistence upon a Damaya or Korasha intermediary, and ordinary anger being documented as threatening conduct.

These reactions shouldn't apply universally. Individual relationships, recognized rank, sponsorship, reputation, and demonstrated familiarity can overcome personal prejudice. Katalash-majority communities and institutions designed around Katalash bodies impose none of these disadvantages.

A Katalash character should feel the effects of refusing assimilation, but their social treatment should be capable of changing through play.